GAURAV GANDHI
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EXPERIENCE

2026 **GENER8TOR** (*nationally ranked accelerator network)* **Chicago, IL**

Investment Accelerator Associate

- Facilitated a stakeholder design thinking workshop, turning user insights into a platform strategy that moves the operating model from episodic to continuous and scales contract value from $8.7M to up to $19.2M.
- Shipped a self-updating funding database built with generative AI tools, pulling 19 sources daily; defined match acceptance criteria and ran user acceptance testing with 5 founders, gathering ~12,700 listings, 291 matches
- Wrote the PRD for a voice-first founder diligence interview tool (7 modules, 15 scoring factors), defining requirements, the data model and a 4-phase build plan, and piloted the v0 MVP at the accelerator midpoint
- Drove cohort operations for Great Lakes Innovation Accelerator, a $13.4M program providing $100k in non-dilutive funding to 5 water-tech startups through 1:1 mentorship, investor connections, and founder trainings

2025 **KEARNEY, PRODUCT EXCELLENCE RENEWAL LAB** (*Hardware & Engineering Practice)* **Chicago, IL**

Summer Associate, PERLab

- Built the stage-gate toolkit for a client's 2-year heavy industrial NPI process implementing a 7-level engineering systems model, standardizing platforms to speed proposal planning across 13+ product lines (6 platforms)
- Turned 5 years of manufacturing change-order data (~5,000 records) into a prioritized roadmap worth $15M+ in savings, clustering root causes by type and department to show 85% traced to high-impact fixes
- Built a skills matrix from a 500-person, 90-question survey mapped across 6 departments, benchmarking present vs. needed skills against job descriptions to flag cross-functional competency gaps and inform upskilling

2024 **RACE ENERGY** (*pre-series A (~$15M valuation) electric vehicle start up)* **Hyderabad, India**

Strategy Development Manager

- Uncovered ~$30K in savings through financial modeling, roughly 1% of the company's valuation at the time
- Ran market, competitor, and regulatory analysis across 7 states to build a 2-to-7-state expansion strategy

2018 - 2023 **MICHELIN** (*2nd largest tire manufacturer, $23B market cap)* **Shenyang, China & Pune, India**

Concept Product Design Analyst ***2022 - 2023***

- Developed and tested Michelin LCA tool contributing to a 30% cut in Scope 1 & 2 emissions and 30% rise in sustainable-material rate; owned go/no-go decisions for 2 APAC B2B products against decarbonization targets
- Shipped an internal decision-support design tool and framework adopted by 12 engineers across ~50 products annually, cutting prototype model development lead times by 80%
- Owned end-to-end development of 2 B2B products from concept to launch; designed and ran controlled experiments (DoE) on prototype variants, improving rolling resistance, mileage and wear by 10–30%
- Built an Analytical Performance Guide for a future tech to replace day-long simulations with analytical factors

Product Development and Industrialization Engineer ***2018 - 2021***

- Owned launch execution and product quality for 2 B2B portfolios across 3 APAC plants, driving 10+ product lines from prototype to volume production (100K units/year) to deliver $50M in annual revenue
- Drove first-pass yield ('Right First Time') to a record 95%+, up from 80%, by rebuilding and deploying 2 internal digital automation tools adopted by 100+ engineers across 5 teams

EDUCATION

2024 - 2026 **KELLOGG SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT | MCCORMICK SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING** **Evanston, IL**

NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY | GMAT: 760

MMM Dual Degree: MBA and MS Design Innovation; (Dean's List, Major: Operations)

- **Capstone (JPMorgan Chase)**: Led human-centered discovery and PoC development of 4 AI-powered features for a B2B banking platform; tested feature concepts with 20+ finance leaders, validating 4.6/5 adoption intent
- **Kellogg RAG:** Built a production generative AI chatbot (RAG; Python, LlamaIndex, Pinecone, Gemini) with neural reranking, conversational memory and confidence-based guardrails over 375+ documents
- **Winner, Kellogg Design Challenge:** Won the world's largest MBA design competition with 80+ participants
- **Abrams Climate Fellow:** Selected as one of 30 graduate fellows across 6 graduate schools at Northwestern, led team of four to build climate-tech investment thesis through 20+ expert interviews (VCs, Founders, LPs)

2014 - 2018 **BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY & SCIENCE, PILANI** **Pilani, India**

B.E. (Hons.) Mechanical Engineering

- Winner, Reverse Engineering, Head of Fundraising & Aero, Formula Student Team: Raised 40% of team budget

ADDITIONAL DATA

- ***Skills and tools:*** Product management, human-centered design, design thinking, user research, PRDs, road mapping, MVPs, PoCs, KPIs, change management, generative AI (RAG, Claude Code), Python, SQL, Tableau
- ***Community & Interests:*** ultramarathon (x2), IRONMAN 70.3mi, chocolate chip cookie connoisseur